The International Job Market for Economists

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The Job Market

Overview of Markets

The European Market

- Dates and location: Dec 14-17, 2026, virtual.
- Important websites:
  - European Economic Association: https://www.eeassoc.org.
  - Job listings: https://www.eeassoc.org/jeeh-position-listings.
  - European Job Market of Economists: http://www.europeanjobmarketofeconomists.org.
- X/Twitter: @EEANews
- More job postings: https://www.econjobmarket.org.

The U.S Market (ASSA Annual Meeting)

- Dates and location: Jan 3-5, 2027, Washington, DC.
  - Typically there is also a virtual option.
- Important websites:
  - American Economic Association: http://www.aeaweb.org/conference/.
  - Job listings: http://www.aeaweb.org/joe/listings.
- X/Twitter: @JOE_listings
- More job postings: https://www.econjobmarket.org.

Financial Management Association (FMA)

- Dates and location: Oct 14-17, 2026, Tampa, Florida.
- Important websites:
  - Financial Management Association: http://www.fma.org/for-job-seekers.

About the Market

Types of Positions

- Tenure-track assistant professor.
- Visiting assistant professor.
- Limited time junior faculty:
  - Post-doc.
  - Assistant professor.
- Private sector postings: research associates, analysts, etc.

Market participants

- Demand:
  - Universities.
  - Government agencies.
    - Central banks: Fed, ECB, BoE, etc.
    - Supervisory bodies: SEC, FDIC, etc.
  - International organisations: IMF, World Bank, BIS.
  - Companies.
- Supply:
  - Recent Ph.D. graduates.
  - Students within a year of completion of Ph.D.
  - Senior assistant professors and post-docs.

Process (Universities)

1. Application (September–November of year $t-1$).
2. Screening interview online (or at European / ASSA meeting).
   - 20 minutes long.
   - Between 10–30 candidates for each position.
3. Fly-out to university:
   - One full day: Seminar talk, meeting with different faculty members, department head, maybe dean, dinner.
   - About 3-4 candidates per position.
4. Offer and negotiation.
5. Start job (typically August–September of year t).

Application

Application

- Contents:
  - Job market paper.
  - CV.
  - Cover letter
  - Extras:
    - Teaching portfolio.
    - Teaching evaluations.
    - Research and teaching statements.
- Sent separately:
  - Reference letters (usually 3, one of which is from the supervisor).
- The material can be uploaded and updated on a `Job Openings for Economists (JOE)` profile (U.S.) or an `Econ Job Market (EJM)` profile (Euro), so subsequent applications are easier.

Other things to prepare

- Web site.
- Spreadsheet with applications, deadlines, names of contacts, etc.
- Presentation of job market paper ("job market talk"):
  - A 45-minute version (Europe).
  - An 80-minute version.
  - 1-minute, 3-minute, and 5-minute oral summaries (spiel).
- Present your job market paper at our department, conferences, other universities if you can.
- Other things:
  - Professional-looking clothing for the interviews/flyout helps.
  - Make sure your phone, laptop, cloud storage, backup, credit cards, passports, visa-status is all working and sorted.

Thoughts on Where to Apply

- Trickle-down, expect to go down in ranking.
- Initial job has lasting effects on career and productivity.
- Post-doc versus assistant professor.
- Realistic prospects of tenure.
- Average number of applications per candidate about 100 (U.S.).
- Would you actually want to live there?

Guide and Calendar

Guide and Calendar

- Cawley wrote a nice guide for the job market:
  - See here.
  - But keep in mind that it has not been updated since before covid.
- A rough calendar for the process can be found on my website.